

Cognitive Defusion Practice

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Cognitive defusion (ACT) helps you unhook from sticky thoughts by changing your relationship to them rather than their content. You are not your thoughts — you are the one noticing them. Practice the techniques below with a real thought that hooks you.

A thought that hooks me (write it exactly as it shows up):

Defusion techniques to try

- Name the story: 'I'm having the thought that...' then 'I notice I'm having the thought that...'
- Thank your mind: silently say 'Thanks, mind' for the warning, without obeying it.
- Silly voice / singing: say the thought in a cartoon voice or sing it to a familiar tune.
- Repeat a key word aloud for 30 seconds until it loses its meaning and becomes just a sound.
- Leaves on a stream: picture each thought placed on a leaf and floating away.

How 'fused' was I with the thought before (0–10)?

After practicing defusion, how 'fused' am I now (0–10)? What shifted?

If this thought no longer ran the show, what valued action would I take?